

Great Sword

[!NOTE]
Please refer to the [MHWI Damage Formula](#) and [MHWI General Data Sheet](#) by MoonBunnie & Deathcream for up to date information.

The Great Sword (GS) is a slow, heavy weapon that sacrifices attack speed for attack strength. Learning how to use the GS effectively requires good positioning, anticipation, and understanding of the GS's attack timings.

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Strength & Weakness

Strength	Weakness
• High damage output per swing • Decent Reach • Can Block • Less dependent on Sharpness maintenance	• Slow movement speed • Slow attack speed • Attack animations have long recovery times

Charge Slashes

The Great Sword can empower its slashes by charging them. The GS has 3 kinds of charged slashes: the **Charged Slash**, the **Strong Charged Slash**, and the **True Charged Slash**. Each charged slash has three different charge levels, Levels 1 to 3. Overcharging a charged slash will reduce its strength to Level 2.

[[images/greatsword_charge)

Left to right: Level 1, Level 2, Level 3, and overcharged slash

The Hunter glows brighter when a charge level is gained. When the Hunter reaches Level 3, they will perform a quick squatting motion. This helps the player in timing the attack.

[[images/greatsword_optimal)

Left to right: Level 3 Charged Slash, Level 3 Strong Charged Slash, Level 3 True Charged Slash

If the player is hit, knocked away, evades, or stops the attack combo while charging a slash attack, the player will lose all the charge they've gained.

Combat Tips

- Due to its slow speed and attacks, reckless play with the GS will expose the player to danger.
- After an attack, the player can roll sideways or forward to recover quicker.

- Tackle (<<C>>) allows the player to brace for incoming attacks without knockback. Timing it in response to a monster's attack allows the player to continue their Charged Slash combo without interruptions.
- The Level 3 charged slash is performed by releasing <<T>> at the right time. Overcharging will cause Level 3 charged slashes to revert to the power of a Level 2 charge, so timing is critical to maximize damage.
- Although Level 3 charged slashes are preferable, landing a Level 2 charged slash is still better than missing completely with a Level 3 charged slash.
- The GS's slow attack and large [[motion values|damage#motion-value]] makes its more suitable at dealing [[physical damage|damage#damage-type]].

Movelist

In addition to the GS Charge Slashes above, the GS has a multitude of other attack chains. Mid-air attacks are done in the air, such as after hopping off a ledge, jumping off a vine, or climbing up a wall and jumping off.

Move	Button (+Condition)	Properties
Charged Slash	Draw Attack > <<T>>	Can be charged (Hold <<T>>).
	Standing/Walking > <<T>>	Can be cancelled into a Tackle (<<T>>) while charging. Holding <<T>> during Tackle will perform a Strong Charged Slash. Performing this without holding <<T>> will change the attack to Overhead Slash. After release, it can be comboed into: • Side Blow <<T>> • Rising Slash <<T>>+<<C>> • Wide Slash <<C>> • Strong Charged Slash Back+<<T>>
Overhead Slash	Draw Attack > <<T>>	Performing this while holding <<T>> will change the attack to Charged Slash.
	Standing/Walking > <<T>>	After release, it can be comboed into: • Side Blow <<T>> • Rising Slash <<T>>+<<C>> • Wide Slash <<C>> • Strong Charged Slash Back+<<T>>
Strong Charged Slash	After a Charged Slash > Back+<<T>>	Can be charged (Hold <<T>>).
	After a Tackle from a Charged Slash > <<T>> After a Tackle during Evade > <<T>>	Can be cancelled into a Tackle <<C>> while charging. Holding <<T>> during a Tackle will perform a True Charged Slash. After release, it can be comboed into: • Side Blow <<T>> • Rising Slash <<T>>+<<C>> • Strong Wide Slash <<C>> • True Charged Slash Back+<<T>>
True Charged Slash	After a Strong Charged Slash > Back+<<T>>	Can be charged (Hold <<T>>).
	After a Tackle from a Strong Charged Slash > <<T>>	Can be cancelled into a Tackle <<C>> while charging. Holding <<T>> during a Tackle will perform a True Charged Slash.
Wide Slash	<<C>>	Can be comboed into: • Tackle <<C>> • Charged Slash <<T>> • Rising Slash <<T>>+<<C>>
	During Evade > <<C>>	
Rising Slash	<<T>>+<<C>>	Can be comboed into: • Wide Slash <<C>> • (Strong) Charged Slash <<T>>
		If a Rising Slash is comboed from a Strong Charged Slash, then a Strong Charged Slash can be comboed after
Evade		Reset current Charged Slash Level to a normal Charged Slash.
	With weapon out <<X>>	Short window to combo into: • Tackle <<T>> • Wide Slash <<C>>
Side Blow		This attack combos into:
	After any Charged Slash > <<T>> After a Jumping Wide Slash > <<T>>	• Rising Slash <<T>>+<<C>> • Wide Slash <<C>> • (strong) Charged Slash <<T>>
Tackle		Brace for incoming attacks to minimize flinching and damage taken. This attack combos into: • (current) Charged Slash <<T>> • Jumping Wide Slash <<C>> • Side Blow R2+<<T>>
Tackle	While charging a Charged Slash > <<C>>	Upgrade a Charged Slash to a Strong Charged Slash.
	During a Wide Slash > <<C>> During an Evade > <<C>>	Evadeing will reset the Charged Slash, and then the Tackle will upgrade to a Strong Charged Slash

Move	Button (+Condition)	Properties
Tackle	While charging a Strong Charged Slash > <<C>>	Upgrade a Strong Charged Slash to a True Charged Slash
Tackle	While charging a True Charged Slash > <<C>>	Maintain at a True Charged Slash
Strong Wide Slash	After a Strong Charged Slash > <<C>>	This attack combos into: - Strong Charged Slash <<T>> - Wide Slash <<C>>
	After a Midair Charged Slash > <<C>>	
	After a Plunging Thrust > <<C>>	
Jumping Wide Slash	Short window during a Tackle > <<C>>	Reset to a normal Charged Slash Combo into a Side Blow <<T>>
Charged Rising Slash	While Sliding > <<T>>	Hold <<T>> while sliding to charge, release <<T>> to attack. This attack can combo into a Plunging Thrust <<T>> midair. When sliding stops, it turns into a normal Charged Slash.
Plunging Thrust	Mid Air after a Charged Rising Slash > <<T>>	Combo into a Strong Wide Slash (<<T>>/<<C>>)
Midair Charged Slash	Mid Air > <<T>> Mid Air Draw Attack > <<T>>	Can be charged (Hold <<T>>). Releasing early or without a charge mid air will perform a Jumping Slash. This attack combos into a Strong Wide Slash (<<T>>/<<C>>)
Guard	R2	The player holds the sword out as a shield to block the attack, incurring a Sharpness loss.

Motion Values

Section has been moved to the database.